

EG Russia-Ukraine Crisis: Black Sea strikes threaten Ukraine grain export revenue

送信者: EG Europe 受信日時: 2026-07-24 01:39

[【メール原文】](#)

Russia-Ukraine Crisis

23 Jul 2026 12:37 EDT

Black Sea strikes threaten Ukraine grain export revenue

-
- * Russian strikes will likely keep disrupting Ukraine's Black Sea grain exports as Russia retaliates against attacks on its shipping and Ukraine suffers from a shortage of air defense interceptors.
 - * The strikes against Ukraine's ports aim to undermine its export revenue, disrupt arms deliveries, and create pressure on Kyiv to stop its own attacks on Russian maritime targets.
 - * If the disruption lasts, the fallout will be broad, undermining a key source of foreign currency for Ukraine and giving Russia added leverage through the pain inflicted on major grain importers such as Egypt, Algeria, and Indonesia.
-

The grain squeeze will probably persist. Ukraine's Agriculture Minister Taras Vysotskyi said on 23 July that traffic had stopped around Odesa after an almost two-week Russian campaign against Ukrainian Black Sea ports. He stressed that Kyiv had imposed no restrictions and that ports remained physically operational. However, about 90% of shipowners have suspended port calls because insurance premiums have risen and risks remain high.

This shutdown in Black Sea vessel traffic could last longer than previous ones, as Russia has intensified its strikes against Ukrainian ports. Russia and Ukraine are now locked in a tit-for-tat escalation that Kyiv has pledged to sustain. Earlier waves of attacks in November-December 2025 and January-February 2026 failed to halt Ukrainian maritime traffic for long. The current episode differs in scale and intensity as Russia responds to Ukraine's expanding campaign against Russian shipping and inland infrastructure. Because both sides remain committed, the escalation is likely to sustain itself. The risk premium keeping shipowners out of the market will therefore decline slowly.

Ukraine's air defense vulnerabilities are amplifying the impact of the strikes. Moscow has intensified attacks on Odesa, Chornomorsk, and Pivdennyi. It is using Iskander-M ballistic missiles, Oniks anti-ship missiles, and mass drone raids. Ukraine lacks enough US-supplied Patriot interceptors, the only systems that can reliably stop those missiles. Ukraine has deployed its available batteries to defend cities and

military supply lines, so shifting them to ports would be costly. As long as strikes continue to hit their targets, war-risk insurers will have no reason to reduce premiums.

Moscow aims to weaken conditions inside Ukraine and erode allied support. Russia wants to disrupt seaborne deliveries of military goods to Ukraine and put additional pressure on state finances. Maritime grain exports are a major source of foreign revenue, so strikes on port infrastructure carry clear fiscal costs.

Russia also aims to use higher global food prices to generate diplomatic pressure on Ukraine. Moscow hopes that governments in the Global South, and possibly even some European governments affected by the disruption, will press Ukraine to scale back its strikes on Russian infrastructure and de-escalate. Among price-sensitive Global South buyers, Egypt obtains about one-quarter of its wheat imports from Ukraine, while Indonesia obtains about 18% of these imports from Ukraine. Europe also faces risks through feed grains and vegetable oils. Ukraine is the EU's largest corn supplier and provides about 92% of the bloc's sunflower oil imports.

The effort is unlikely to succeed in generating diplomatic pressure. European governments are unlikely to push Ukraine to pause its strikes. Political support for Ukraine within the EU remains strong, and many governments view the deep strikes as legitimate. Governments in the Global South have less leverage over Ukraine and may instead blame Russia for the supply disruption. We don't expect a renewal of the UN-brokered agreement of July 2022 that permitted the safe commercial export of grain and foodstuffs from three key Ukrainian ports.

Rerouting is plausible but would raise export costs. Kyiv can move grain through the Danube, Romanian ports, and rail, as it did at the start of the war. Each alternative, though, raises freight and logistics costs and narrows margins against cheaper Russian supply. It also has physical constraints and cannot replace the maritime export route completely.

Kyiv is also concerned that a larger reliance on overland exports could worsen relations with Poland and Romania. When Ukraine last increased grain shipments through Poland by road and rail, it triggered sustained protests from Polish and Eastern European farmers and truckers, who blockaded the border against Ukrainian goods. A renewed westward flow could reignite those tensions just as Kyiv needs EU solidarity most.

Ukraine's fiscal position is likely to deteriorate as export revenue falls. Grain is a top source of foreign currency, as agricultural products represent 60% of goods exports. Even a temporary disruption would deepen the structural erosion of Ukraine's export markets, as price-sensitive buyers shift to South American and Russian grain. The timing is also damaging, as Ukraine is gearing up for the harvest season and traders need to clear grain storage.

Global South countries are most vulnerable to any price shock. Egypt, Algeria, and Indonesia together bought 62% of Ukrainian wheat in 2025-2026, with Egypt alone importing 3.9 million tons. Wheat prices are already at a two-year high. A prolonged disruption would fall hardest on these budget-constrained buyers, giving Ukraine a humanitarian argument against the strikes even as Russia attempts to weaponize the same issue as diplomatic pressure against Ukraine.

europa@eurasiagroup.net

Alexander Kolyandr

Director, Europe

kolyandr@eurasiagroup.net

Dani Podgoretskaya

Analyst, Europe

+44 203.769.8223

danip@eurasiagroup.net

Pietro Guglielmi

Analyst, Geoeconomics

+44 207 375 6937

guglielmi@eurasiagroup.net

PDF or Print | Get the EG iOS or Android mobile Apps for content on the go

Explanation of Political Trajectories (ie, "Trajectories")

Eurasia Group's (EG) Political Trajectories are indicators of the net impact of political factors on the macro business environment in a country over specific timeframes. For each country, two Trajectories are provided, a short-term (6 months) and a long term assessment (24 months). Trajectories are assigned by Eurasia Group's country analysts through a structured qualitative process. Each Trajectory represents a net assessment, indicating how political changes in a country impact the macro business environment, defined as the economic and investment climate in the country. Once initiated, Trajectories are updated both periodically and as events warrant. Trajectories may be suspended from time to time if there is no active analyst opinion or analyst coverage, but the opinion or coverage is expected to resume. Trajectories can be:

Positive: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a positive impact on the macro business environment

Neutral: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a neutral or negligible impact on the macro business environment

Negative: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a negative impact on the macro business environment

Disclaimers: Trajectories are solely for informational purposes and should not be relied upon as investment advice. Trajectories do not indicate asset price movements, and have no value in forecasting market prices. Trajectories are based on data and analysis we deem to be reliable; they are not guaranteed as to accuracy or completeness. The Trajectories indicate the political outlook in a single country, over time. Trajectories do not address sector-specific or city/regional political risks that are often different than the country-level outlook. Trajectories represent an analyst's net qualitative assessment of a country's political outlook. EG sales, analytic staff and products may provide analysis reflecting different opinions than those expressed by the Trajectories.

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-WF-DocID wfpub_eurasia_26941_f2cbdbe3

[To manage your email preferences click here](#) | [To manage your research content alerts click here](#)